

Philipp Hilbert. *Payment systems and operational hub ownership.*

Positioning, ten years shipping transactional products, from P2P payments to PSP integrations, now focused on owning the full payment hub lifecycle for a fast-scaling operator.

BERLIN, GERMANY · [HILBERT@TRUE-NORTH.BERLIN](mailto:hilbert@true-north.berlin) · [TRUE-NORTH.BERLIN](https://true-north.berlin)

[LinkedIn](#) · [GitHub](#) · www.true-north.berlin · [YouTube \(EN sample\)](#)

§ WHY GROWE

Growe is rebuilding its payment hub from the ground up rather than accumulating workarounds, making system behavior explicit, owning the back office, and sequencing a live regional migration with rollback plans baked in from day one. That is not a typical PM brief; it requires someone comfortable reading API contracts, tracing a transaction across eleven systems, and writing requirements that leave no ambiguity for engineers or partner gateways. The focus on validation via small percentages of live traffic and historical transaction replays rather than a big-bang cutover is exactly the kind of staged, evidence-driven approach I have used across regulated environments. *That is precisely the environment where structured discovery and cheap experiments pay the highest dividend.*

§ AI-NATIVE STACK

Daily tools, not buzzwords.

- **Claude Code**, in-repo spec and edge-case generation
- **GitHub Copilot**, accelerated requirements drafting
- **Cursor**, inline refactors and API contract review
- **Lovable**, rapid front-end prototyping
- **GPT**, discovery synthesis and stakeholder drafts
- **Gamma.app**, internal alignment decks
- **n8n**, agentic workflow automation

- **Jira + Confluence**, backlog and documentation
-

§ TECHNICAL ENVIRONMENT

Shipped with, not just listed.

REST APIs, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Kafka, Python, Kotlin (Spring Boot), Kubernetes, Docker, ArgoCD, GitOps, CI/CD, Jenkins, GitLab, Azure DevOps, Dagster, dbt, ETL pipelines, Figma, Miro.

§ SIDE PROJECT

CONSTRUCT8 [GITHUB.COM/HILBERTP](https://github.com/HilbertP) →

Two-sided B2B staffing marketplace, built zero-to-one as a solo founder.

- Designed and shipped an anonymity-until-payment model protecting both firms and workers until commitment is made.
 - WhatsApp and Telegram as the primary product surface, keeping onboarding friction near zero.
 - LLM agents across the full funnel so a single operator runs day-to-day matching and follow-up.
 - Funnel and conversion analysis in SQL, the same metrics discipline a payment hub demands for approval rates and failure reasons.
-

§ HOW I WOULD WORK AT GROWE

First weeks, concrete.

WEEK 1

Listen, map, find the gaps.

Shadow the seven back-office screens in live use, trace one complete transaction lifecycle across the eleven internal systems (wallet, KYC, fraud, reconciliation), and log every undocumented assumption about callback timeouts, withdrawal hold rules, and gateway configuration that currently lives only in engineers' heads.

WEEK 2

Rank and spike.

Run timeboxed discovery spikes on the highest-risk unknowns identified in week one, starting with the integration points most likely to cause rework, and produce a ranked risk register with explicit resolution criteria.

WEEK 3+

Sequence and ship.

Define the first rollout stage for the regional migration: validation rules, the traffic percentage for the live test, historical replay criteria, and a written rollback plan, so the first region goes live with no surprises for local operations or support teams.

I COVER LETTER

Dear Growe Hiring Team,

Payment infrastructure is unforgiving: a misconfigured callback timeout or an undocumented withdrawal hold rule surfaces not as a ticket but as a blocked payout at two in the morning. I have spent a decade in regulated, transaction-critical environments, founding Kvitt Payment Solutions and taking it through to acquisition by Sparkasse inside the girocard ecosystem, integrating PSP flows at Scheidt & Bachmann's forecourt and POS estate, and owning end-to-end delivery at EMIL Group's B2B SaaS insurance platform, and the single most consistent lesson is that ambiguity at the system boundary is always more expensive than the time it takes to eliminate it upfront.

The Payment Product Manager role at Growe maps directly to where I do my best work. Making system behavior explicit, callback timeouts, hold and release rules, gateway configuration, player-facing error messages, is requirements engineering at its most consequential. I write requirements with explicit outcomes, clear acceptance criteria, and well-defined boundaries as a matter of discipline, not process compliance. At CLINET Platforms I cut a roadmap to its top ten percent against agreed success measures and raised user acceptance more than fivefold; at Rohde & Schwarz I instrumented two competing workflows to let data choose the product direction rather than preference. The same rigor applies to a payment hub: I will not guess at what a gateway does under timeout; I will write it down, get it confirmed, and put it in the spec.

The regional migration sequencing is the piece I find most interesting. Defining rollout stages, setting validation rules on small percentages of live traffic, running historical transaction replays, and maintaining clear rollback plans is exactly the staged, evidence-driven approach I used when migrating the Bundesagentur für Arbeit's bare-metal analytics platform fully into containers while keeping a national policymaker-facing service live throughout. Small

experiments make expensive decisions safe; that principle scales directly to a live payment migration across regional operators who each have their own support and business stakeholders to keep informed.

I am also comfortable with the cross-system discovery the role demands. Reading API contracts and tracing a transaction independently across eleven systems, player accounts, wallet, KYC, fraud, reconciliation, taxation, is the kind of structured spike work I find clarifying rather than exhausting. I have done equivalent mapping in defence AI pipelines (FCAS), in hospital information system integrations, and in crypto infrastructure. The fintech and payments domain is where I started my career and where my instincts are sharpest.

Grove is building something that has to work reliably at scale, across regions, with real money on every transaction. That is a brief I take seriously.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*

II CURRICULUM VITAE

§ BEARING

Product manager with 13 years of ownership across regulated, transaction-critical environments, payments, fintech, insurance, public-sector analytics, and defence AI. I turn system complexity into explicit requirements, lead cross-functional teams through structured discovery, and sequence migrations and platform launches so that unknowns are resolved before development starts, not during it. At Grove I would own the payment hub end-to-end: system behavior definition, back-office operational health, regional rollout sequencing, and the ongoing integration discipline that keeps a live hub stable.

§ WHAT I CAN DO

Payments and fintech: P2P payment product ownership, PSP and gateway integration, transaction lifecycle tracing, approval rates, failure analysis, cost per transaction, acceptance criteria for financial flows.

Requirements and discovery: continuous discovery, risk-first spike design, MVP and PoC scoping, explicit acceptance criteria, definition of done, edge-case generation, LLM-assisted spec drafting.

Agile and scaled delivery: Scrum, Kanban, SAFe, ART, PI planning, backlog refinement, velocity and burndown, release gating, GitOps rollout and rollback.

Data and analytics: funnel and churn analysis, ETL (extract, transform, load), Dagster, dbt, PostgreSQL, KPI definition, Matomo, MicroStrategy, SQL.

Technical environments: REST APIs, Kubernetes, Docker, ArgoCD, CI/CD, Jenkins, GitLab, Python, Kotlin, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Kafka, Git.

AI products and tooling: LLM agents, agentic workflows, prompt engineering, human-in-the-loop design, EU AI Act, Explainable AI (XAI); prototyping with Claude Code, GitHub Copilot, Cursor, Lovable.

Stakeholder and leadership: cross-functional team leadership (15+ engineers), C-level reporting, workshop facilitation, conflict resolution, change management, Deputy IT Security Officer.

Governance: GDPR, identity management, budget ownership, ROI reasoning, audit trails.

§ PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

ROHDE & SCHWARZ · PRODUCT MANAGER · DEFENCE AI / DATA PLATFORM 2024-2025

GitOps rollout with ArgoCD cut deployment from days to 30 minutes; pipeline runs up 200% after redirecting strategy to developer-code-first based on instrumented workflow data; led 15+ engineers and data scientists through Scrum on the FCAS programme.

BUNDESAGENTUR FÜR ARBEIT · PRODUCT MANAGER · PUBLIC-SECTOR ANALYTICS 2023-2024

Integrated test automation into Jenkins, introduced Dagster and dbt saving ~75% of time per data update, and migrated a bare-metal platform fully into containers while keeping the national service live; also served as Deputy IT Security Officer.

CLINET PLATFORMS · PRODUCT OWNER · HEALTHCARE MOBILE APP 2023

Cut roadmap to top 10% against agreed success measures; user acceptance rose fivefold. Shipped CGM/KIS integration reducing digital anamnesis from 30 minutes to 5.

EMIL GROUP · PRODUCT MANAGER · INSURANCE B2B SAAS 2022

Restructured an 18-person delivery org into three lean teams; senior engineer attrition fell from near-total exodus to one departure. Shipped Claims Center from concept to production; cut time-to-market for new insurance product launch from months to under a week.

SCHEIDT & BACHMANN · PRODUCT OWNER INTEGRATION · RETAIL
PAYMENTS / POS 2021-2022

Moved research results into production across a matrix organisation in a full SAFe setup with agile release trains and PI planning; owned POS and forecourt payment system integrations.

BUNDESDRUCKEREI · PRODUCT OWNER (INTERIM) · GOVERNMENT SECURE
DATA 2021

Data structures and identity management for the Robert Koch Institute's DIM and DESH programmes.

AOK ITSCARE · PRODUCT OWNER (PROXY) · HEALTH INSURANCE E-
COMMERCE 2019-2020

Migrated a legacy procurement system to Shopware for three AOK insurers and ~20,000 employees; backlog refinement, user stories, and acceptance criteria in Jira.

ENERCON · PROJECT LEAD · WIND ENERGY IT 2019

Full site IT modernisation end to end.

WALDBURG-ZEIL KLINIKEN · PRODUCT OWNER · HEALTHCARE CLINICAL
NETWORK 2017-2018

Wifi infrastructure rollout across nine hospitals.

§ FOUNDER & EARLY-STAGE EXPERIENCE

CONSTRUCT8 · FOUNDER AND PRODUCT MANAGER · CONSTRUCTION
STAFFING MARKETPLACE 2025-PRESENT

Zero-to-one two-sided B2B marketplace with LLM agents across the funnel; funnel and conversion analysis in SQL.

QCRYPT AG · CO-FOUNDER AND PRODUCT OWNER · QUANTUM-SECURE
ENCRYPTION 2016-2021

Shipped a three-layer hardware/software product that installs in under two minutes; later Chair of the board.

SMART SOIL TECHNOLOGIES · CO-FOUNDER, CDO AND CFO ·
NANOTECHNOLOGY / AGRITECH 2018-2021

Took a nanotechnology fertiliser from lab to investor rounds; owned financial planning and investor reporting.

KVITT PAYMENT SOLUTIONS · FOUNDER AND CFO · FINTECH P2P
PAYMENTS 2013-2018

Built a mobile group-based P2P payment product from zero to acquisition by Sparkasse,
operated inside the girocard ecosystem.

§ LANGUAGES

German, native. English, C2.

[LinkedIn](#) · [GitHub](#) · www.true-north.berlin · [YouTube \(EN sample\)](#)

TRUE NORTH · APPLICATION PACKAGE · GROWE

